Getting started with OpenDocViewer

OpenDocViewer (ODV) is the window where you read documents when you open them from your organization's portal or archive system. This guide covers what you need day to day: finding the right page, zooming and printing. It takes a few minutes to read.

Want to do more? Three more guides cover the rest: **Selection**, **Compare two pages** and **More features**. You will find them in the section Want to know more? at the bottom, and each one is also available as a separate PDF.

The pictures show a made-up test document with no real data. The screenshots show the Swedish interface; switch ODV to *English* in the language menu (the globe) to see the button names used in this guide. Click an image to see it larger – click again to close. Download the guide as PDF.

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7. Print

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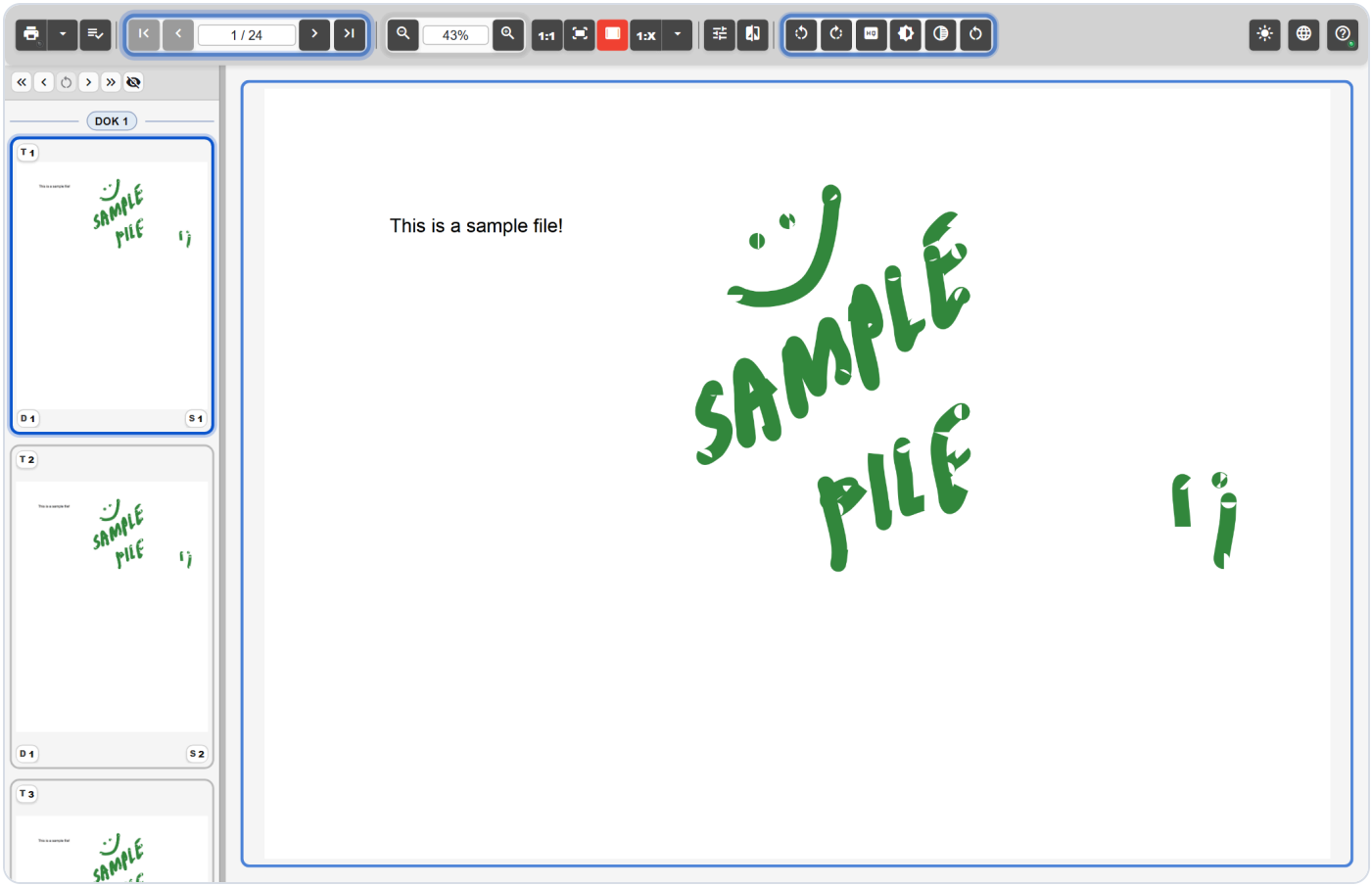
10. Remember

11. Want to know more?

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1. The three parts of the window

ODV has three parts: the **toolbar** at the top, the **thumbnail pane** on the left and the **document** in the middle. The page you are looking at has a blue frame, both in the middle and in the thumbnail pane.



Overview. Toolbar at the top, thumbnails on the left, document in the middle. The blue frame shows which page you are looking at.

Two words that come up throughout the guide:

- **Document** – one record with one or more pages. If you open several documents at once, each document gets a heading in the thumbnail pane: *DOC 1*, *DOC 2* and so on (*DOK 1*, *DOK 2* in the Swedish screenshots).
- **Session** – all the documents you opened together from the portal or archive system. The pages are numbered in one sequence through the whole session.

Back to the system you came from

ODV is opened from another system – a portal, an archive or a business application. You return there with that system's own buttons or by closing the ODV tab. What that looks like depends on your organization.

2. Wait until everything has loaded

Once you have opened the documents, ODV fetches the pages. While that happens, the page box in the toolbar is striped and the print and selection buttons are gray. When the stripes disappear, everything is ready.



Loading. Striped page box and gray print and selection buttons – wait.



Ready. The page box is no longer striped, and the print and selection buttons can be used.

At the very start, before the pages appear, you may see the *Preparing documents* box with a progress bar. If you open a very large number of pages at once, the *Large document batch detected* box may appear: choose **Continue anyway** to load everything, or **Stop loading**. If you go to a page that has not loaded yet, *Loading pages… Please wait.* is shown for a moment where the page should be.

▾ **Why is the light on the print button off?**

The small light on the print button shows whether ODV prepares a PDF of all pages in advance, so that printing all pages goes faster. The tooltip calls this the *print cache*, and it is something your organization may have switched on. If the light is off, that is normal, and you can print as usual. The light on the help button at the far right means something else, see If something goes wrong.

3. Find the right page

Pick whichever way suits you – you can mix them.

- **Click the arrow buttons** in the toolbar: *First page*, *Previous page*, *Next page* or *Last page*. Hold an arrow down to page through quickly.
- **Type the page number** in the box between the arrows and press `Enter`.

- **Click a thumbnail** in the pane on the left.
- **Scroll with the mouse wheel.** When you reach the bottom of the page and keep scrolling, a small gauge fills up and then the next page is shown (your organization may have turned this off). Scrolling up works the same way.

<details>
<summary>With the keyboard: page through and jump between documents</summary>

- `Arrow Down` / `Arrow Up` or `Page Down` / `Page Up` change page. Hold the key down to page through quickly.
- `Home` and `End` go to the first and the last page.
- `Arrow Right` does not change page – it opens compare mode. Press `Arrow Left` twice to close it again (see the guide Compare two pages).
- With several documents open: hold `Ctrl` down, and the arrow buttons as well as `Arrow Down`, `Arrow Up`, `Home` and `End` jump a whole *document* instead of a page (`Page Down` and `Page Up` do not). The page navigation gets a dashed frame to show this.



Ctrl held down. Dashed frame around the page navigation = the arrows change document, not page.
</details>

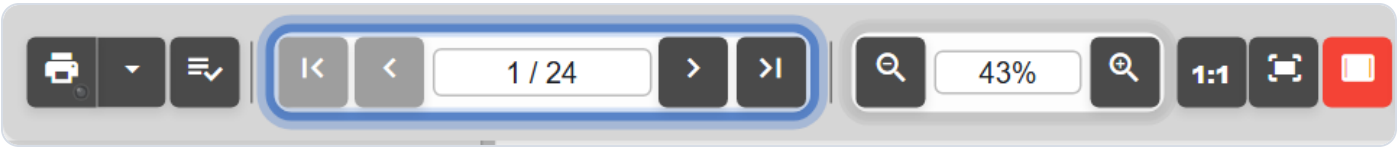
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4. Zoom and fit

The zoom buttons come right after the page navigation in the toolbar. The fit option that is selected is red.

- **Zoom out** and **Zoom in** (the magnifying glasses) change the zoom by about ten percent at a time. You can also type a percentage in the box between them, from 5 to 800.
- **Actual size (1:1)** shows the page at 100 %.
- **Fit to screen** shows the whole page at once.
- **Fit to width** fills the width. It suits most documents and is how the page is shown to begin with, unless you or your organization have chosen something else.

Quickest: double-click the page to switch between *Fit to width* and *Fit to screen*.



The left part of the toolbar. From the left: print, selection, page navigation, zoom out, percentage box, zoom in, 1:1, fit to screen and fit to width (red = selected).

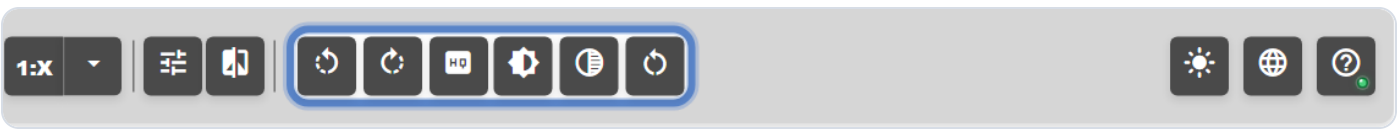
▾ More ways to zoom

- `+` and `-` on the keyboard zoom in and out. So does `Ctrl` + the mouse wheel over the page.
- When the page is larger than the window, you can drag it with the mouse to move around. The mouse pointer then turns into a hand.
- The **1:X** button (*Custom size*) shows the page at a size you have set yourself, and the **HQ** button makes a PDF page even sharper. Both are described in the guide More features at the bottom of the page.

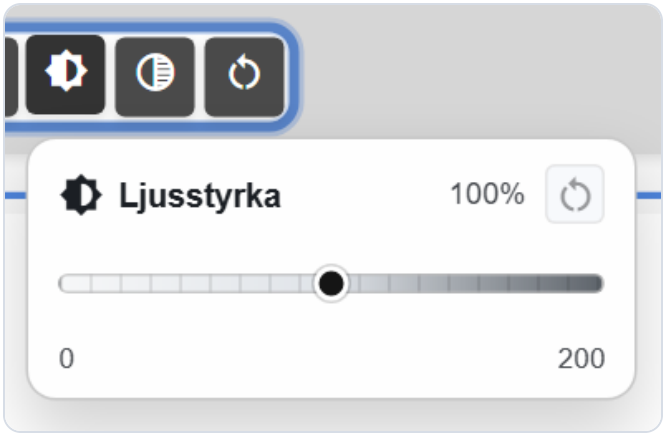
5. Rotate the page or adjust brightness and contrast

Is the page on its side, or is a scanned page too dark or too faint? The buttons on the right of the toolbar help you.

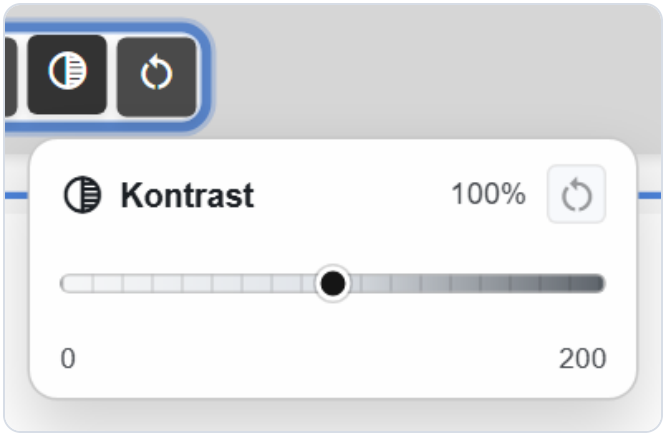
- **Rotate left 90°** and **Rotate right 90°** turn the page a quarter turn.
- **Adjust brightness** and **Adjust contrast** each open a slider from 0 to 200, where 100 is unchanged. Drag the slider or click on the scale. The button with the round arrow in the slider box sets the value back to 100. The **Adjust brightness** or **Adjust contrast** button in the toolbar stays red as long as its value is not 100.
- **Reset adjustments** (the last button in the group) removes the rotation and resets brightness and contrast, all at once.



The right part of the toolbar. First 1:X with its arrow, *Fine tuning* and compare. In the group with the blue frame: rotate left, rotate right, HQ, brightness, contrast and reset. At the far right theme, language and help.



Brightness. Drag the slider or click on the scale. The button at the top right sets it back to 100.



Contrast. The same slider and the same scale, 0–200.

Important: the changes are temporary. They only affect how the page is shown to you right now – nothing is saved in the archive. ODV remembers them per page for as long as the documents are open; the next time the document is opened it looks as usual again.

Want the changes on paper? Choose the print method **Active page** when you print (see Print). Every other print method prints the pages as they are in the archive.

With the keyboard: `Ctrl` + `Arrow Left` and `Ctrl` + `Arrow Right` rotate the page a quarter turn, just like the buttons. The sliders snap to 100 for every value between 80 and 120. For a smaller change, type the value in the *Fine-tune* panel, described below.

Is the page only slightly tilted? The **Fine tuning** button (the sliders, right after 1:X) shows the *Fine-tune* panel above the page. There you can turn the page 0.1° at a time, move and zoom it, and switch it to grayscale or invert its colors. The panel is described in the guide Compare two pages, but it works just as well when you look at a single page. If the button is missing, your organization has switched it off.

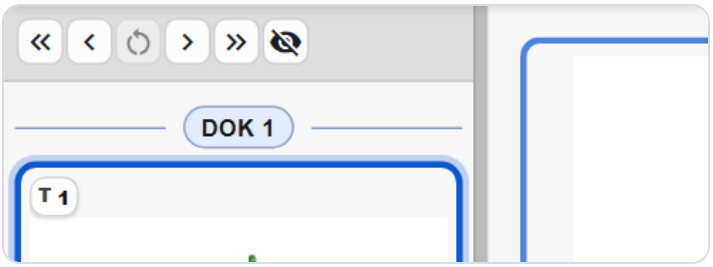
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6. Use the thumbnail pane

The pane on the left shows every page as a small picture. With several documents open, *DOC 1*, *DOC 2* and so on appear above each document. Click a thumbnail to go to that page.

The buttons at the top of the pane change its width: minimum width, narrower, default width, wider and maximum width. The crossed-out eye (*Hide thumbnails*) hides the pane.

A narrow strip remains at the far left, and the *Show thumbnails* button at the top of it brings the pane back. You can also drag the edge between the pane and the document.



The pane buttons. Five buttons for the width, then the eye that hides the pane. Below them the heading *DOK 1* (*DOC 1* in English) and the first thumbnail.

Every thumbnail has small badges in its corners:

T – the page's number among the pages shown right now

D – the document number

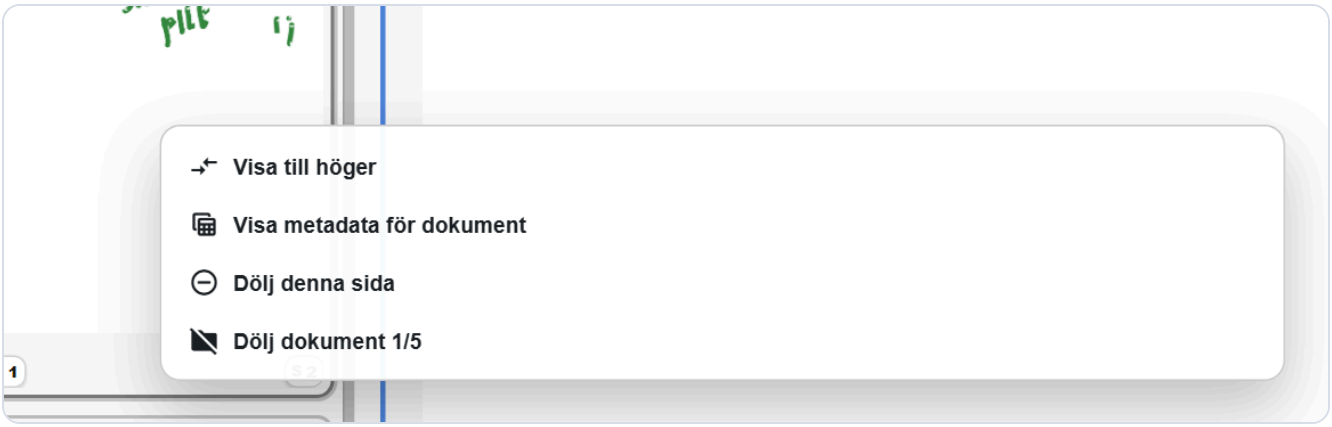
P – the page number within the document

D and P are only shown when the session has several documents. If you make a selection, T only counts the pages that remain. With several documents open, the list ends with the *END* marker. In the Swedish screenshots the third badge is S.

▾ Right-click a thumbnail: show to right, metadata, hide

Right-click a thumbnail for a menu with up to four options:

- **Show to right** – opens the page next to the one you are looking at. See the guide Compare two pages.
- **Show document metadata** – information about the document, such as ID, department and date. Which fields exist depends on the system you came from, and the option is only there when that system sent some along and your organization has not turned the metadata display off.
- **Hide this page** and **Hide document 1/5** (the document's number and the number of documents) – removes the page or the whole document from view. This is called a *selection* and has its own guide: Selection.



The right-click menu. Show to right, Show document metadata, Hide this page and Hide document 1/5.

You get the same menu, minus *Show to right*, when you right-click the page in the middle.

Signed PDF documents. If a PDF document is digitally signed, a signature symbol is shown on the document's thumbnails (and next to the *DOC* heading when you have several documents), plus a signature button in the toolbar, unless your organization has turned the signature display off. Click the symbol to see who signed and whether the document is unchanged since it was signed. What the colors of the symbol mean is described in the guide More features at the bottom of the page.

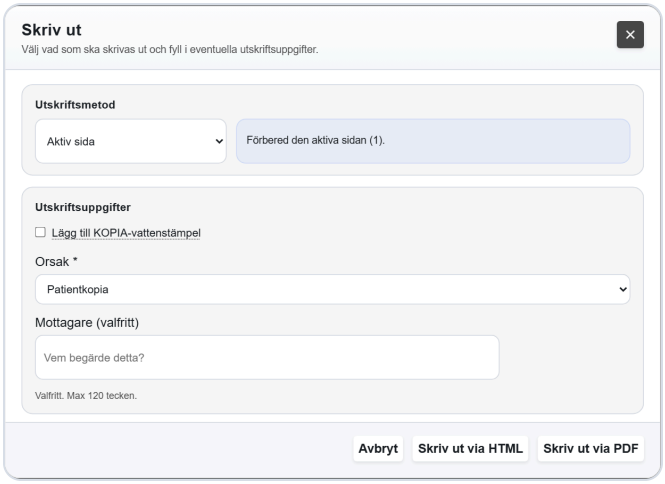
7. Print

This is how you print the page you are looking at, or all pages.

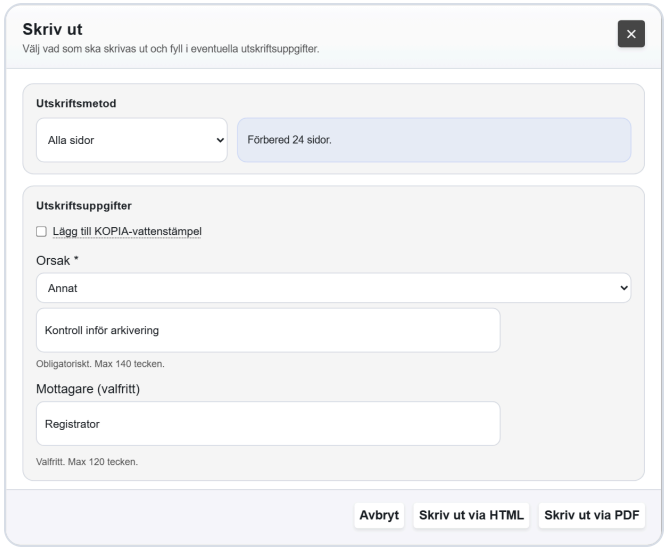
1. Click the **print button** (*Print*) at the far left of the toolbar. `Ctrl` + `P` normally works too.
2. Choose a print method: **Active page** (the page you are looking at, exactly as it looks) or **All pages** (every page in the session as they are in the archive, or normally only the pages in the selection if you have made a *selection*).
3. Choose a **Reason** and fill in **Recipient** if you like. If *Reason* is a list, a reason is normally already selected (the first one) – check that it is the right one.
4. Check **Add copy watermark** if the printout is not an original. The box is normally unchecked to begin with, and your organization may have hidden it.
5. Click **Print via HTML** or **Print via PDF**, depending on which buttons you have. The browser's print window opens, and there you choose a printer as usual.

Your organization decides which fields exist, which are required and which reasons you can choose between. If something required is missing, the dialog shows a red message and does not print until you fill it in. For example, if you choose the reason *Other* without typing any text, it says *Please enter additional details for the selected reason.*

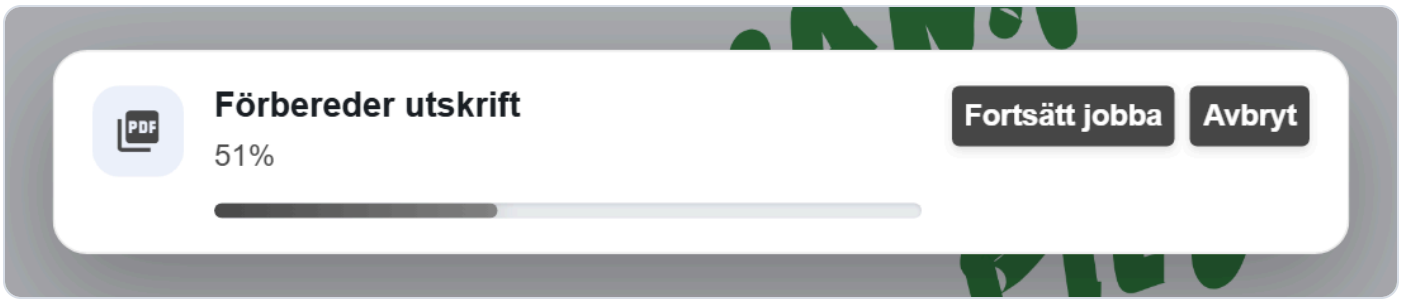
The difference between the two buttons: **Print via HTML** opens the browser's print window straight away. **Print via PDF** lets ODV create a PDF of the pages first – you see the *Preparing print* box – and then sends it to the browser's print window. If you have the **Save PDF** button, it saves that same PDF as a file instead of printing it. Do not press `Enter` in the *Reason* or *Recipient* field if you meant to print via PDF: `Enter` starts **Print via HTML** straight away.



The print dialog. *Print method* at the top, *Print details* below. Here with *Active page* and the standard settings: the watermark checkbox is empty and the first reason is preselected.



Print details. Here with *All pages*, a reason with free text and a recipient filled in.



Preparing print is shown after you choose *Print via PDF*. Wait until it is done – the print window opens by itself. *Cancel* stops it after you confirm.

The printout can automatically get a header and a footer with information your organization has chosen – for example date, user, reason, recipient and page number – and the watermark if you selected it.

This is a sample file!

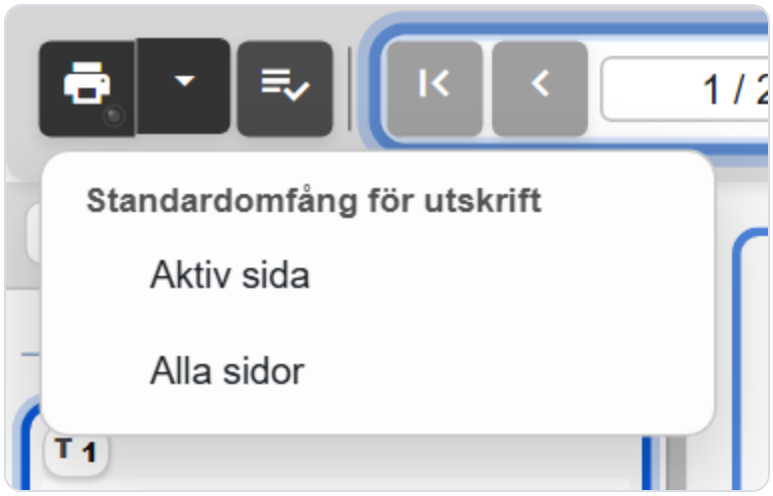


KOPIA

Example of a printout. Header, footer and watermark are set up by your organization.

▾ **More print options**

- **The arrow next to the print button** (*Print defaults*) decides whether the dialog opens with *Active page* or *All pages* preselected. ODV remembers your choice.
- Under *Print method* there are also **Simple range** (from one page to another, for example 2–10) and **Custom pages** (a list, for example *1-3, 7, 9-5*, separated by spaces or commas). The pages are printed in the order you type them, and a page may appear more than once.
- **Continue working** in the *Preparing print* box moves it to the bottom of the window so you can keep reading. When the PDF is ready, click *Open print*.
- After a print via PDF, the **Reuse latest print settings** button normally appears at the top right of the dialog (a small icon, a clock with a circular arrow; its tooltip says *Fill in the dialog with the same choices as the latest print*). It fills in the same choices as last time.
- Some organizations also have the **Automatic page orientation** checkbox: each page gets portrait or landscape format according to the page image when you print via PDF.
- Want to print only some pages from several documents? Make a *selection* first – see the guide Selection at the bottom of the page.

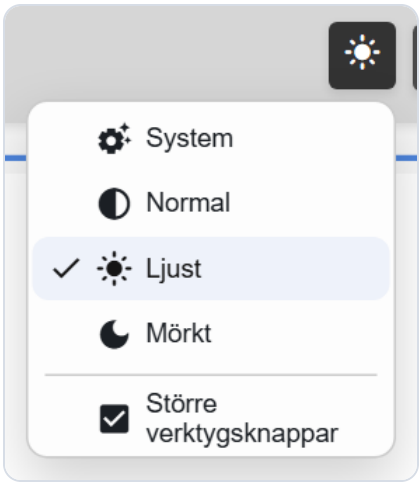


The arrow next to the print button. The *Default print scope* menu sets the preselected method.

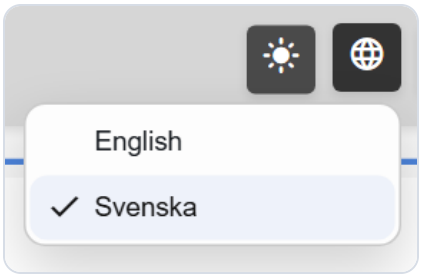
8. Theme, language and manual

At the far right of the toolbar there are three menus. ODV remembers your choices for next time.

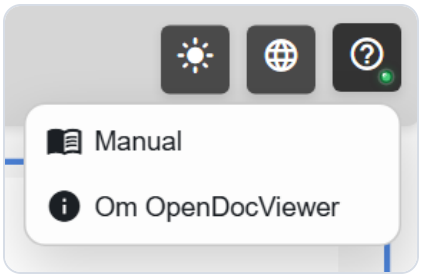
- **Choose theme** (the icon shows the current theme): *System* follows your computer's light or dark setting, *Normal* and *Light* are two light looks, and *Dark* makes the interface dark while the document page is shown as usual. The *Larger toolbar buttons* checkbox switches between larger and smaller buttons in the toolbar.
- **Choose language** (the globe): *Svenska* or *English*. All text changes immediately. Does ODV show the wrong language the first time you open it in a browser? Choose the language here, and ODV remembers your choice.
- **Open help menu** (the question mark): *Manual* opens this guide in its own window, and *About OpenDocViewer* shows the version and contact details.



Theme. *System*, *Normal*, *Light* (selected) and *Dark*. At the bottom the *Larger toolbar buttons* checkbox.



Language. *English* or *Svenska* (selected).



Help. *Manual* and *About OpenDocViewer*. The green light on the button means everything is normal.

In the manual window you can **search**: type at least two characters in the *Search the manual* field and the matches are highlighted; `Enter` jumps to the next match. On the left is the table of contents – click a heading to jump there. In a narrow window, open it with the *Contents* button. The *Reload manual from server* button fetches the latest version of the guide.

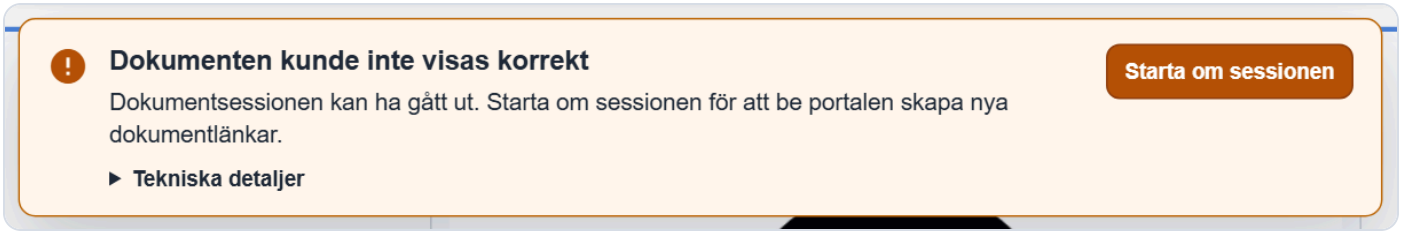
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9. If something goes wrong

The pages are shown as warning triangles

The document links from the portal or archive system may only be valid for a limited time. If you have had ODV open for a long time, the pages may stop being displayed and

the box *The documents could not be shown correctly* appears at the top. Click **Reset session**: the page reloads and the documents are fetched again. If that does not help, close ODV and open the document again from the system you came from.



Click Reset session. The picture shows an installation with its own message text and only that button. Normally *Reload viewer* and *Dismiss* are there as well.

Other common situations

- **A single page shows a warning triangle** and the text *Error: The document is corrupted, missing, or in an unsupported format.* The other pages work. The file may be damaged or in a format ODV cannot show. Open the document again from the system you came from, and contact support if the error remains.
- **The print button is gray.** The pages are still loading – wait until the page box is no longer striped. The button is also gray while a PDF is being prepared for an earlier print.
- **Pages are missing from the thumbnail pane.** A selection is active – the selection button in the toolbar is red. Click the red button at the top of the pane (*Clear the selection filter and show all pages*). If the selection hides every page, ODV instead shows the *Show all pages* button in the middle of the window.
- **The page is blurry.** If it is a PDF page, the **HQ** button (*Increase PDF page resolution*) can make it sharper. Pages that are image files, such as scanned images, are already shown as sharp as they are.
- **The light on the help button is orange or red.** Orange means ODV is running in a memory-efficient mode. Red means a loading error, or that the memory protection has kicked in. If pages are missing and the box *The documents could not be shown correctly* is shown, click *Reset session* there; otherwise contact support.
- **The *Something went wrong* box appears.** Click *Try again*, and if that does not help, *Reload*.
- **The toolbar is gone and only thumbnails are shown.** The window is too narrow. Below about 600 pixels wide, ODV shows only the thumbnails. Make the window wider and the toolbar and the page come back.

▾ **If you need to contact support**

Contact your local support in the usual way. Include two things in the ticket:

1. **The version.** Open the help menu and choose *About OpenDocViewer*. The version is at the top.
2. **The diagnostics file.** Expand *Diagnostics* in the same box and click *Download diagnostics JSON*. The file contains technical information about ODV – no documents.

What else support can make use of is listed in the guide More features.

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10. Remember

- ✓ Find the page: type the page number in the box and press `Enter`, or click a thumbnail.
- ✓ *Fit to width* suits most documents. Double-click the page to switch to the whole page.
- ✓ Print: wait until the page box is no longer striped, choose *Active page* or *All pages*, check the reason and click *Print via HTML* or *Print via PDF*.
- ✓ Rotation, brightness and contrast only reach the paper with *Active page*.
- ✓ Warning triangles instead of pages? Click *Reset session*.

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11. Want to know more?

That covers everyday use. Three more guides cover the rest. Expand them below – they open on this page – or download them as separate documents.

Selection – as PDF

Choose the pages that are shown and printed. Opens as a separate document.

Compare two pages – as PDF

Side by side, fine tuning, overlay, curtain and printing. Opens as a separate document.

More features – as PDF

Metadata, signatures, sharper PDF pages, keyboard shortcuts and more. Opens as a separate document.

This guide covers OpenDocViewer 2.11. Your organization may have set up some features differently. Updated 2026-10-25.